

098. Chapter 8 Verses 1-4

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 8.1

| 8.1-2

अर्जुन उवाच |
किं तद्ब्रह्म किमध्यात्मं किं कर्म पुरुषोत्तम |
अधिभूतं च किं प्रोक्तमधिदैवं किमुच्यते || 1||

arjuna uvāca |
kiṃ tadbrahma kimadhyātmaṃ
kiṃ karma puruṣottama |
adhibhūtaṃ ca kiṃ proktam
adhidaivaṃ kimucyate || 1 ||

Arjuna said: "O supreme person (puruṣottama), what is that Brahman? What is the individual self (adhyātma)? What is action (karma)? What is declared to be the material manifestation (adhibhūta)? And what is called the divine manifestation (adhidaiva)?"

VERSE 8.2

अधियज्ञः कथं कोऽत्र देहेऽस्मिन्मधुसूदन ।
प्रयाणकाले च कथं ज्ञेयोऽसि नियतात्मभिः ॥ २ ॥

adhiyajñāḥ katham ko'tra
dehe'sminmadhusūdana |
prayāṇakāle ca katham
jñeyo'si niyatātmabhiḥ || 2 ||

- ◆ **adhiyajñāḥ** – Adhiyajna; **katham** – how; **kaḥ** – who; **atra** – here;
- ◆ **dehe asmin** – in this body; **madhusūdana** – O Madhusudana;
- ◆ **prayāṇa-kāle** – at the time of death; **ca** – and; **katham** – how;
- ◆ **jñeyah asi** – are You to be known; **niyata-ātmabhiḥ** – by the self-controlled.

**O Madhusūdana, how is the Lord of ritual (adhiyajña)
present in this body, and how are You to be known at the
time of departure (death) by those who have controlled their
minds?**

VERSE 8.3

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
अक्षरं ब्रह्म परमं स्वभावोऽध्यात्ममुच्यते ।
भूतभावोद्भवकरो विसर्गः कर्मसंज्ञितः ॥ ३ ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |
akṣaram brahma paramam
svabhāvo'dhyātmamucyate |
bhūtabhāvodbhavakaro
visargaḥ karmasaṁjñitaḥ || 3 ||

- ◆ **akṣaram** – imperishable; **brahma** – Brahman; **paramam** – supreme;
- ◆ **svabhāvaḥ** – essential nature; **adhyātmam** – Adhyatma; **ucyate** – is called;
- ◆ **bhūta-bhāva-udbhava-karaḥ** – that which causes the origin and growth of beings;
- ◆ **visargaḥ** – the creative offering/discharge; **karma-saṁjñitaḥ** – is known as Karma;

The Lord said: Brahman is supreme, imperishable. Its essential nature is called Adhyatma (Self-knowledge); the act of sacrifice that causes the birth of beings is named karma (action).

VERSE 8.4

अधिभूतं क्षरो भावः पुरुषश्चाधिदैवतम् ।
अधियज्ञोऽहमेवात्र देहे देहभृतां वर ॥ 4 ॥

adhibhūtaṃ kṣaro bhāvaḥ
puruṣaścādhidaivatam |
adhiyajño'ham evātra
dehe dehabhṛtām vara || 4 ||

- ◆ **adhibhūtaṃ** – Adhibhuta; **kṣaraḥ bhāvaḥ** – perishable nature;
- ◆ **puruṣaḥ** – the Cosmic Person; **ca** – and; **adhidaivatam** – Adhidaiva;
- ◆ **adhiyajñaḥ** – the Lord of sacrifice; **aham eva** – I alone; **atra dehe** – here in the body;
- ◆ **dehabhṛtām vara** – O best among the embodied.

O best of the embodied souls, the physical manifestation that is constantly changing is called adhibhūta; the universal form of God, which presides over the celestial gods in this creation, is called Adhidaiva; I, who dwell in the heart of every living being, am called Adhiyajna, or the Lord of all sacrifices.